

CFO-RC FILE #:

RESULTS:

2001-20

A

COLORADO FIELD ORNITHOLOGISTS SIGHT RECORD FORM.

(Please print or type. Attach photographs, drawings, and additional pages if necessary).

Species: Neotropic Cormorant
(Common Name)

Phalacrocorax brasilianus
(Scientific Name)

Date(s) of observation: April 8, 2001.

Number of birds seen: one.

Sex: unknown.

Plumage: adult alternate.

Exact location: John Martin Reservoir, west of Road 19 boat ramp.

County: Bent.

Nearest town: Las Animas/Fort Lyon.

Length of Observation: 20 minutes.

Time(s) of Observation: around 1030am and after.

Other observers who saw the bird with you: Mark Janos, Stan Oswald.

Other observers who independently saw the bird(s): BB Hahn saw the bird on 9 April 2001.

Light conditions (quality; direction relative to bird(s) position): Excellent. Sun to the east, bird was to the west.

Optical equipment used: B&L 15x60 zoom spotting scope.

Distance from bird (s) (estimated unless otherwise noted): A long ways, perhaps 800 yards. Not really sure.

Was the bird photographed: no.

If so, have you submitted photos? n/a.

Who took the photographs? n/a.

Describe the general and specific habitat in which the bird(s) occurred:

The bird was on a dead tree in the water with other cormorants. John Martin Reservoir is a large man-made reservoir in southeastern Colorado.

Describe the bird's behavior (flying; feeding; habits; behaviors used in identifying the species or in supporting the identification):

While looking through the scope at the numerous cormorants perched in the dead trees in the water at John Martin Reservoir, I noticed a cormorant that looked smaller in size. I then thought I was seeing white feathers bordering the triangular throat patch. So, I mentioned to Mark and Stan that I was looking at a possible Neotropic Cormorant. They too got on the bird and we watched the bird for another 15 minutes at least and concurred that we had found a Neotropic Cormorant. The bird stayed perched on the dead tree in the water for the entire time, there were about 6 Double-crested Cormorants in the same tree.

Describe the bird in detail: This is the most important part of this report. Include overall size and shape, and how you placed the bird in the general group that you did. Give complete details of plumage, including bill, head, eyes, neck, chin, throat, breast, belly, undersides, sides, nape, back, wings, and tail. Give particular emphasis to marks

you used to identify the (bird(s)). Describe other details, such as color and shape of bill, head, neck, legs, eye, etc. That were important in making the identification. (Fill out this portion even if photographs are submitted: you may attach additional sheets, drawings, field sketches, or copy of field notes):

The first thing I noticed about the bird, was the size. It was several inches smaller than the cormorants near it, though was cormorant shaped. The bird had more of a thinner longer neck, a longer tail, and a throat patch that was more yellowish (not orangish) and was more of a triangular shape giving a pointed look away from the bill. There were white feathers bordering this throat patch. The overall color was black like the other cormorants. It had a thinner bill (than the other cormorants) that look yellowish and somewhat long. The eye color wasn't noted. The head and neck were black. The head was smaller and rounded with no crests. The neck was long and thinner than the other cormorants. The back, wings, and tail looked black. The tail was longer and thinner than the other cormorants. The underparts from below the yellowish throat patch to the under tail coverts were all the same black color. The color of legs and feet weren't noted. I am identifying this cormorant as a Neotropic, because of small size, more thinner body, thinner bill, thinner and longer tail, thinner and longer neck, and by the different shape throat patch bordered by white feathers.

Describe the bird's song and calls if heard: None heard.

Discuss similar species and how you eliminated them:

Double-crested Cormorant: All of this was noted above, though to recap, this species is larger, thicker billed, thicker necked, shorter necked, shorter and thicker tail, and thick body overall. Also, the throat patch is orange that the rounded, not pointed. The head shape is larger and is not as rounded and has crests during this time of year.

What is your prior experience with this and similarly appearing species:

Neotropic Cormorant: I have seen a few in Colorado, including two in 2000 in southeastern Colorado, one in Pueblo County and one in Kiowa County. I have also seen them in Colorado once in Crowley County and twice at Ireland Reservoir in Weld County. I have also seen them in Texas, New Mexico, and Arizona.

Double-crested Cormorant: I have seen thousands or more in Colorado and other states, including 100+ at John Martin Reservoir at the same time, including six in the same tree as this other cormorant.

List books, guides, recordings, or other sources consulted and how this influenced you identification (during and after observation): None needed.

This report was made from notes taken
during _____,
or after ☒ observation,
or later from memory_____.

Reporting observer: Brandon K. Percival

. Signature: Brandon K. Percival

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